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(54) **PHYSIOLOGICAL MONITORING METHOD AND SYSTEM**

PHYSIOLOGISCHES ÜBERWACHUNGSVERFAHREN UND -SYSTEM

PROCÉDÉ ET SYSTÈME DE SURVEILLANCE PHYSIOLOGIQUE

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- **John Dittami ET AL: "Sex differences in the
reactions to sleeping in pairs versus sleeping
alone in humans", SLEEP AND BIOLOGICAL
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Description

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0001] The present invention generally relates to physiological monitoring. In particular, but not exclusively, the present invention relates to simultaneous physiological monitoring of two subjects. In particular, but not exclusively, the present invention generally relates to sleep monitoring. In particular, but not exclusively, the present invention relates to sleep monitoring in a double bed.

BACKGROUND ART

[0002] Physiological monitoring is carried out with devices that don't require measuring electrocardiography, electroencephalography or other electrophysiological signals with uncomfortable electrodes, but are based on comfortable movement and audio measurement. The measurements needed for such unobtrusive monitoring are carried out using systems such as microphones for measuring movement sounds, breathing sounds and snoring; movement sensors such as radars, bed-installed force sensors, wearable movement sensors and further sensors for measuring movements, respiration and heart rate.

[0003] Unobtrusive monitoring systems are known e.g. from documents WO2007143535, US8398538, WO2011140113, US8548770 and US7726209.

[0004] When monitoring physiological parameters, e.g. the sleep of a single person sleeping in a bed, practically all measurement data from the unobtrusive sensors relate to the sleeping person, obviously with expected external influences, such as ambient noise, disturbing the measurement. However, when physiological parameters of two or more people are to be monitored, e.g. two people are sleeping in a same bed, unobtrusive monitoring becomes more difficult.

[0005] In a typical measurement scenario each person being monitored would have their own unobtrusive sensor. The output of each sensor will inexorably contain information also on the person who is not meant to be monitored with the sensor in question, i.e. for example a movement sensor of a first person will also detect movements of a second person and vice versa. The magnitude of the problem depends on the unobtrusive sensor employed, e.g. microphones are more prone to pick up signals from several persons.

[0006] Document John Dittami ET AL: "Sex differences in the reactions to sleeping in pairs versus sleeping alone in humans", SLEEP AND BIOLOGICAL RHYTHM, vol. 5, no. 4, 1 October 2007 (2007-10-01), pages 271-276, XP055436697, AU, ISSN: 1446-9235, DOI: 10.1111/i.1479-8425.2007.00320.x discloses that couples sleeping in pairs is a modern phenomenon with potential side-effects on sleep structure and circadian rhythms. In order to examine its effects, 10 healthy heterosexual couples with stable relationships who regularly

sleep apart or together in their home environments were recruited. The participants were asked to spend at least 10 nights alone and 10 nights together over the course of the study. Their sleep was monitored over 28 days in their homes with actigraphic techniques and sleep diaries. Group analyses were performed on their sleep efficiency and subjective sleep quality according to sleep condition. The daily variations in sleep fragmentation indices of the partners were used as a measure of their nocturnal activity synchronization. Sharing a sleeping space with a partner had negative effects on sleep in women, as documented in the actigraphic measurements of sleep efficiency and subjective assessments of sleep and awakening quality. Sexual contact mitigated the negative subjective report, without changing the objective results. Subjective assessments of sleep quality were lower in men than women when sleeping alone. They increased to the same level as women while sleeping in pairs with or without sexual contact. The sleep efficiency in men was not reduced by the presence of their partner unless sexual contact occurred. Analyses of sleep fragmentation showed that there was no synchronization of deviation from the norm levels between the partners on individual nights either when they slept alone or in couples. The sex differences in the nocturnal sleep reactions to partner presence may be attributed to sex-specific behavioral traits associated with cultural norms or parenting in women and the desire for group sleep in men

[0007] Another method for monitoring the sleep of two subjects sleeping in one bed is known from US 2008/030396 A1.

[0008] It is the object of the invention to mitigate the problems related to multi-person physiological monitoring with unobtrusive measurements.

SUMMARY

[0009] The invention provides a method, a physiological monitoring system and a computer program according to the independent claims meet this object. Further embodiments are provided in the dependent claims.

[0010] According to the invention, there is disclosed a method as defined in claim 1.

[0011] The first and the second sensor may be configured to measure a same quantity relating to the subject.

[0012] The quantity may be heart rate.

[0013] The quantity may be respiration.

[0014] The quantity may be related to movement.

[0015] The quantity may be audio signal.

[0016] The event maybe the presence of the subject.

[0017] The event maybe movement of the subject.

[0018] The event may sounds made by the subject.

[0019] Prior to analysis the signals may be transmitted to a control unit.

[0020] The signals may be transmitted independently with added information on the association of the signals to the subjects.

[0021] The signals may be transmitted together.

[0022] The first and second sensors may be unobtrusive sensors.

[0023] The first and the second sensor may comprise force sensors.

[0024] The method may further comprise measuring a quantity relating to the first and/or second subject with a third sensor and/or fourth sensor positioned in or in proximity of the first and/or the second subject and configured to provide a third and/or fourth signal.

[0025] The method may further comprise analyzing the first, the second, the third and/or the fourth signal and their interrelation in order to determine at least one event relating to the first and/or the second subject.

[0026] The third and/or fourth sensor may comprise audio sensors.

[0027] The method may further comprise providing a sleep quality determination based on the analysis.

[0028] According to the invention, there is also provided a physiological monitoring system as defined in claim 5.

[0029] The first and the second sensor may be configured to measure a same quantity relating to the subject.

[0030] The quantity may be heart rate.

[0031] The quantity may be respiration.

[0032] The quantity may be related to movement.

[0033] The quantity may be audio.

[0034] The event may be the presence of the subject.

[0035] The event may be movement of the subject.

[0036] The event may be sounds made by the subject.

[0037] The sensors may be configured to transmit the signals to the control unit prior to the analysis.

[0038] The sensors may be configured to transmit the signals independently with added information on the association of the signals to the subjects.

[0039] The sensors may be configured to transmit the signals together.

[0040] The control unit may be positioned in proximity of the bed.

[0041] The control unit may be integrated into an electronic device.

[0042] The electronic device may comprise a smartphone.

[0043] The control unit may be implemented in a cloud service.

[0044] The control unit may be configured to provide a sleep quality determination based on the analysis.

[0045] The first and second sensors may comprise unobtrusive sensors.

[0046] The first and the second sensor may comprise force sensors.

[0047] The system may further comprise a third sensor and/or fourth sensor positioned in or in proximity of the first and/or the second subject and configured to measure a quantity relating to the first and/or second subject and to provide a third and/or fourth signal.

[0048] The control unit may further be configured to analyze the first, the second, the third and/or the fourth

signal and their interrelation in order to determine at least one event relating to the first and/or the second subject.

[0049] The third and/or fourth sensor may comprise audio sensors.

5 **[0050]** According to the invention there is also provided a computer program comprising computer code, as defined in claim 11.

[0051] Furthermore, there is disclosed a memory medium comprising the computer program of claim 12.

10 **[0052]** Different embodiments of the present invention have been illustrated in the foregoing. The above embodiments are used merely to explain selected aspects or steps that may be utilized in implementations of the present invention. Some embodiments may be presented only with reference to certain example aspects of the invention. It should be appreciated that corresponding embodiments may apply to other example aspects as well.

15 **[0053]** Some example embodiments of the invention will be described with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which:

Fig. 1 shows a schematic example presentation of a system according to an embodiment of the invention;

25 Fig. 2 shows a schematic example presentation of a system according to an embodiment of the invention;

Fig. 3 shows example signals measured by a system according to the invention in a situation with a single person sleeping in a bed;

Fig. 4 shows example signals measured by a system according to the invention in a situation with two persons sleeping in a bed;

35 Fig. 5 shows example signals measured by a system according to the invention in a situation with two persons sleeping in a bed and moving;

Fig. 6 shows example signals measured by a system according to the invention in a situation with two persons sleeping in a bed and one of them snoring; and

40 Fig. 7 shows an example flow diagram of a method according to an embodiment of the invention.

45 DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0054] In the following description, like reference signs denote like elements.

50 **[0055]** Fig. 1 shows a schematic example presentation of a system 100 according to an embodiment of the invention. The system comprises a control unit 150 and at least a first and a second unobtrusive sensor 120a, 120b. The sensors 120a, 120b are in an embodiment positioned for example in or in proximity of a bed 110, or on the subject monitored as hereinafter described, and are configured to provide a first signal and a second signal, respectively. It should be noted that the term double bed is used hereinafter to refer to any sleeping place, such

as a bed, mattress or sleeping sofa, in which several persons are able to sleep and/or lie down, and also to several separate beds in the same space and in proximity of each other. In a further example embodiment each unobtrusive sensor 120a, 120b comprises several separate sensor elements forming a multi-channel sensor. In an embodiment, the unobtrusive sensors 120a, 120b comprise force sensors. The force sensors are in an embodiment positioned e.g. under a bedpost, under a mattress or between a mattress and a bed sheet of a double bed 110 in order to measure for example respiration, heart rate and movement of a first and a second person in the bed, respectively.

[0056] The unobtrusive sensors 120a, 120b comprise in an embodiment elongated strips comprising one or several force sensing elements. The force sensing elements comprise sensor elements such as piezoelectric, capacitive or resistive elements. A skilled person appreciates that any known force sensing element is applicable instead or in addition to the above-mentioned sensor element types. The unobtrusive sensors 120a, 120b comprise in an embodiment movement sensors or accelerometers, installed in the bed or worn by the subject, and/or radars.

[0057] The control unit 150 comprises elements configured to carry out functionalities such as signal analysis, communications, storing and displaying of data. The control unit 150 comprises elements (not shown) known in processing devices, such as processors, memory units, communication circuits, I/O (input/output) units, user interface units, connectors and antennas. The control unit 150 is connected to the unobtrusive sensors either with hardware connectors or wirelessly using wireless communication such as Bluetooth, wireless local area network (WLAN) or proprietary radio communication protocols. In a further embodiment, the control unit is implemented using a remote server system, such as a cloud service or implemented as an application on an electronic device such as a smartphone, a tablet computer, a television or a table computer. In a still further embodiment, the control unit, or the functionalities thereof, are implemented into the unobtrusive sensors 120a, 120b.

[0058] Fig. 2 shows a schematic example presentation of a system 100 according to an embodiment of the invention. Again, the system comprises a control unit 150 as hereinbefore described and unobtrusive sensors. As hereinbefore previously described, the system comprises two or more unobtrusive sensors configured to monitor physiological parameters, e.g. sleep, of a person or persons, or subjects A and B. Fig. 2 shows types of unobtrusive sensors configured for sleep monitoring, such as a radar 230a, for example a doppler radar, a microphone 240a and a smartphone 250a, the sensor elements comprised in which are utilized in the system. Furthermore, the subjects A and B are shown wearing wrist actigrams 260a, 260b. It is to be noted that in a further embodiment, other unobtrusive sensor types are used, for example sensors measuring a quantity relating to movement of a

subject. For example in addition to or instead of wrist actigrams, systems attachable to arm, or head of a subject could be used. Furthermore, in an embodiment instead of or in addition to wrist actigrams, for example smart watches or smart glasses, or clothes with integrated electronics, i.e. smart clothing, is used. In accordance with embodiments of the invention, two or more sensors of the same type or two or more sensors of different types are used, for example two force sensors and a microphone are used together.

[0059] According to the invention, the respiration, heart rate, movement, and/or sounds of a person or persons for example sleeping in a bed are measured by one or more sensors. It should be noted that the person or persons need not sleep, i.e. the sensors measure the variables independent of the actual sleeping state, and are also applicable in situations other than sleeping. In case there are several persons in the bed and depending on the type of the sensors and their position, each sensor signal comprises data not only concerning a single person but also data pertinent to the other person. In accordance with the invention, each person is monitored individually, despite the cross-talk between the sensors. The amount of cross-talk between the sensors, i.e. how strongly for example the heartbeat of the person sleeping on one side of the bed shows up on the sensor signal of the person sleeping on the other side, depends for example on the type of sensor used. For example audio is carried over very strongly, but e.g. on a force sensor the movements of both persons are strongly registered whereas the cross-talk in heartbeat signal depends for example on the type of mattress and sensor placement.

[0060] The sensors provide signals on a subject or on both subjects, and on several quantities relating to physiological parameters of the subjects, and to e.g. monitoring their sleep. As hereinbefore described the signals can be measured with different types of sensors. The sounds caused by the subjects or external sources are measured with an audio sensor, such as a microphone, for example integrated into an electronic device such as a smartphone. The movement and respiration of the subjects is measured with audio sensors, force sensors in or in proximity of the bed, video-based sensors, radars and/or wearable sensors as hereinbefore and hereinafter described. The heart rate of a subject is measured with force sensors, radars and/or wearable sensors as hereinbefore and hereinafter described.

[0061] In an embodiment, the respiration and/or heartbeat signals are measured on both sides of the bed, for example using elongated force sensor strips as depicted in Fig. 1. The signals from the sensors are analyzed with different methods, e.g. by comparing different characteristics of the signals. For example, the length of respiration cycles, the beginnings of the cycles or the ends of the cycles are compared between the signals. In a further embodiment, the signals are analyzed using statistical or probabilistic methods and/or methods based on information theory, such as mutual information, entropy or

correlation with time delay. In an embodiment the signal analysis is carried out with a suitable algorithm implemented with software and/or hardware in the control unit 150. In an embodiment wherein the control unit is implemented in cloud based service or as an application in an electronic device, the algorithm is implemented in the same.

[0062] Both sensors provide a signal, and the signals and their interrelations are analyzed in order to determine events relating to the subjects in bed, e.g. a state of the subjects in bed, such as present or awake, and/or actions relating to the subjects in bed, such as moving, changing sleeping posture, or making sounds. Fig. 3 shows an example of respiration/heartbeat signals 310a, 310b from a first sensor and from a second sensor. The horizontal axis of the chart shows time in minutes and the vertical axis shows the level of the signal, for example the voltage or current provided by the sensor. Respiration and heartbeat events in signals 310a, 310b are synchronized, which will be detected with the signal analysis, and accordingly, only a single person is present in bed. Furthermore, a comparison of the levels of the signals shows that the person on the side of the first sensor 310a, i.e. subject A, is present.

[0063] Fig. 4 shows an example of respiration/heartbeat signals 410a, 410b from a first sensor and from a second sensor. Again, the horizontal axis of the chart shows time in seconds and the vertical axis shows the level of the signal, for example the voltage or current provided by the sensor. Respiration and heartbeat events in signals 410a, 410b are not synchronized, which will be detected with the signal analysis, and accordingly, two persons, subjects A and B, are present in bed. Furthermore, a comparison of the levels of the signals shows that levels of the signals are comparable, the signal level obviously being affected also by other factors than presence of the subject, such as the sleeping position of the subject. In an embodiment, first criteria for determining whether a person is present, is that the amplitude of the signal of the respective sensor exceeds a predetermined level, and after the first criteria has been fulfilled, the synchronization of signals is checked. Furthermore, in an embodiment, if it is determined that one of the subjects is not present, no further analysis are carried out for that subject.

[0064] In a further embodiment, the presence determination is further improved by taking into account the movements of the persons in bed, since entering or exiting the bed requires major movement that will likely show up on any sensor signal. Accordingly, the signal analysis algorithm or algorithms used may be configured to maintain the presence state of the subject until a major movement is detected, i.e. a person present in bed cannot exit the bed without a major movement being detected. In an embodiment, such constraint in the presence analysis is implemented for example by modeling the present/absent states as a hidden Markov model and constraining that the transition from present to absent

and vice versa can only happen during movement.

[0065] Fig. 5 shows an example of respiration/heartbeat signals 510a, 510b from a first sensor and from a second sensor with movement being detected. Again, the horizontal axis of the chart shows time in minutes and the vertical axis shows the level of the signal, for example the voltage or current provided by the sensor. Detection of movements is an important part of sleep monitoring and analysis of quality of sleep. When more than one person is sleeping in a bed, the movement of each person shows in each sensor signal, i.e. also the sensor on the other side of the bed or meant for the other person records the movement. The magnitude of the measured movement depends on the sensor type. Sensors that have a large receptive area, such as radars, pick up strong movement signals in these situations. Fig. 5 shows a situation 520a in which both subjects move, and the movements show up with large amplitude in both signals 510a, 510b. Furthermore, Fig. 5 shows a situation 530a in which subject A makes abrupt movements which show up strongly in the signal 510a of the corresponding sensor. The movements of subject A also show up in the signal 510b of the other sensor. As the signals are analyzed, it is inferred that the subject, in the signal of which the movement shows up with a larger magnitude or amplitude has moved, especially if the signal morphology of the movement is similar in both sensors. Furthermore, if both signals show a similar amplitude and/or greatly differing signal morphologies, both subjects are deemed to have moved as in the beginning of the signal sequence of Fig. 5. In a further embodiment, depending on the properties of the bed and the sensors, the movement of subject B will show up in the signal of subject A with a small delay, which can further be used to refine the analysis.

[0066] In a further embodiment, the movement analysis is refined by assessing the pre- and post-movement sleeping posture of the subjects by analyzing the sensor signals recorded prior to and after the detected movement. In a further embodiment, a multi-channel sensor is used in order to more precisely determine the movements and the sleep characteristics thereinbefore and thereafter. In a still further improvement, the movement signals are analyzed in order to determine the disturbance caused to subject A by subject B moving, by analyzing movements of subject A subsequent to the detection of subject B having moved. Similarly, it is possible to determine the significance of one of the two sleeping persons leaving the bed to the sleep quality of the remaining person.

[0067] As hereinbefore described, several types of sensors are in an embodiment used simultaneously. In an embodiment, an audio sensor such as a microphone is used to measure sounds of the sleeping person or persons. In an embodiment for example mobile phone(s) of the person or persons sleeping is used as an audio sensor. Fig. 6 shows an example of respiration/heartbeat signals 610a, 610b from a first sensor and from a second sensor with a third signal 620 from a third sensor that is

an audio sensor. Again, the horizontal axis of the chart shows time in seconds and the vertical axis shows the level of the signal, for example the voltage or current provided by the sensor. The signal 620 shows a periodic detection corresponding to snoring of one of the subjects in bed. When both the subject A and subject B are present in bed, it is important for sleep monitoring to recognize which subject is snoring.

[0068] In Fig. 6 it is determined that subject B is snoring as signal analysis reveals that the signal from the audio sensor is synchronized with the respiration signal 610b. In a further embodiment, a more complicated signal analysis is used to determine the snoring of both subjects, as in such a case the signal 620 from the audio sensor will be in some way synchronized with both signals 610a, 610b. If the signal 620 from the audio sensor is independent from both signals 610a, 610b an external source is causing the sounds. In an embodiment with several audio sensors, the signal levels of both are compared in analogous manner to that described hereinbefore with respect to movement and presence. In a further embodiment, the recorded audio signal is compared with other signals in order to define the disturbances caused to the sleep of the subjects. For example, a movement recorded subsequent to noise may indicate that the sleep of the subject moving was disturbed and the quality of sleep reduced. In a further embodiment, one breathing sound signal and the respiration signal of subject A are measured, and based on the synchronization of the audio and respiration signals it is determined whether subject A snores.

[0069] Fig. 7 shows an example flow diagram of a method according to an embodiment of the invention. At step 710a, 710b the sensors A and B measure a quantity related to a sleeping person, such as respiration and heart rate as hereinbefore described. Furthermore, in an embodiment, an audio signal is also recorded as hereinbefore described at 710c. The sensors A and B provide signals comprising respiration, heart rate and movement information on subjects A and B. The respiration and heart rate in each signal mainly relates to subject A or B respectively, i.e. the carryover is not significant. However, the movement of a subject shows up on both signals. The audio signal comprises the sounds of both subjects and of external sources.

[0070] At 715 the signals from the sensors are processed and transmitted. In an example embodiment the signals are transmitted locally to a locally positioned control unit and analyzed therein. In such a case, after analysis the signals and/or results of the analysis are in an embodiment sent for example to a web service accessible with a personal computer or a mobile application. In a further embodiment, the signals are transmitted independently to a control unit implemented as a cloud service or as a mobile application. In such a case the origin of the signals, i.e. that the signals are associated to the same bed and to each other is identified for example with a location tag inserted into the signal. In a further em-

bodiment, the locally positioned control unit, such as an electronic device, e.g. a smartphone, comprises a user interface through which the signals and the results of the signal analysis is accessible.

[0071] Subsequent to signal transmission, the signals are analyzed as hereinbefore described. The presence of the subjects in bed is analyzed at 720 in order to determine whether subjects A and/or B are present at 725. The movement of the subjects is analyzed at 730 in order to determine the movements of the subjects and their interrelations at 735. The audio signals are analyzed at 740 in order to determine whether subjects A and/or B are causing sounds, and the effect of the sounds on the other subject at 745. The analysis 720-745 are carried out concurrently and interlaced, in such a way that the results of an analysis step are in an embodiment used in further analysis in addition to or instead of the raw sensor signals.

[0072] At 750, the results of the signal analysis are combined to form a sleep monitoring analysis as to sleep quality of the subjects. The sleep monitoring analysis includes an analysis of the interaction of subjects A and B, if any. The result is shown and stored independently for subjects A and B at 760a, 760b for example in a web service or application accessible to the subjects. In an example embodiment, the results for each subject contains information 762a-768a, 762b-768b on the presence, movements, snoring, and interference or disturbances caused by the other subject moving or making sounds. A skilled person appreciates that further analysis are in an embodiment carried out, and further measurement data if available is used in such further analysis. For example the type of movements may be analyzed or the sleep quality may be scrutinized further, especially if electroencephalography or electrocardiography data is available, in order to find micro-arousals and cardiac arousals.

[0073] The foregoing description has provided by way of non-limiting examples of particular implementations and embodiments of the invention a full and informative description of the best mode presently contemplated by the inventors for carrying out the invention. It is however clear to a person skilled in the art that the invention is not restricted to details of the embodiments presented above, but that it can be implemented in other embodiments using equivalent means or in different combinations of embodiments without deviating from the scope of the invention, which is defined in the claims.

[0074] Furthermore, some of the features of the above-disclosed embodiments of this invention may be used to advantage without the corresponding use of other features. As such, the foregoing description shall be considered as merely illustrative of the principles of the present invention, and not in limitation thereof. Hence, the scope of the invention is only restricted by the appended claims.

Claims**1.** A method of sleep monitoring comprising:

measuring (710a) a quantity relating to a first subject (A) with a first sensor positioned on or in proximity of the first subject (A) and configured to provide a first movement signal;
 measuring (710b) a quantity relating to a second subject (B) with a second sensor positioned on or in proximity of the second subject (B) and configured to provide a second movement signal;
 the first subject (A) and the second subject (B) being in a bed (110);
 analyzing, using a control unit, the first signal, the second signal, and an interrelation of the first signal and the second signal to determine a movement event relating to one of the first subject or the second subject; the analyzing comprising:

detecting a first signal amplitude associated with the movement event in the first signal and a second signal amplitude associated with the movement event in the second signal;
 comparing the first signal amplitude to the second signal amplitude, and a delay between the movement event in the first signal and the movement event in the second signal; and
 assigning the movement event to one of the first subject or the second subject based on the comparison.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the quantities are selected from a group comprising: heart rate, respiration, quantity related to movement, and audio.**3.** The method of any preceding claim, further comprising measuring the quantities relating to the first and/or second subjects (A, B) while in the bed (110) with a third sensor and/or fourth sensor positioned in or in proximity of the first and/or the second subjects (A, B) and configured to provide a third and/or fourth signals, the method further comprising performing a third analysis, the third analysis including an analysis of the first, the second, the third, and/or the fourth signals and their interrelation in order to determine the effect of the event relating to the first and/or the second subjects (A, B).**4.** The method of any preceding claim, further comprising providing a sleep quality determination based on the analysis.**5.** A physiological monitoring system (100) for sleep monitoring of a person while sleeping in a bed (110),

comprising:

a first sensor positioned in the bed (110) and configured to measure a quantity relating to a first subject (A) and to provide a first movement signal;
 a second sensor positioned in the bed and configured to measure a quantity relating to a second subject (B) and to provide a second movement signal; and
 a control unit (150) configured to:
 analyze the first signal, the second signal, and an interrelation of the first signal and the second signal to determine a movement event relating to one of the first subject or the second subject; the analyzing comprising:

detecting a first signal amplitude associated with the movement event in the first signal and a second signal amplitude associated with the movement event in the second signal;
 comparing the first signal amplitude to the second signal amplitude, and a delay between the movement event in the first signal and the movement event in the second signal; and
 assigning the movement event to one of the first subject or the second subject based on the comparison.

6. The system (100) of claim 5, wherein the quantities are from a group comprising: heart rate, respiration, quantity related to movement, and audio, and wherein the events are selected from a group comprising: a presence of the second subject (B), movement of the second subject (B), and sounds made by the second subject (B).**7.** The system (100) of claim 5 or 6, wherein the control unit is integrated into a smartphone.**8.** The system (100) of any of claims 5 to 7, wherein the control unit is configured to provide a sleep quality determination based on the determined interrelation.**9.** The system (100) of any of claims 5 to 8, wherein the first and second sensors comprise unobtrusive sensors, wherein the first and the second sensors comprise at least one of force sensors, wearable movement sensors and radars.**10.** The system (100) of any of claims 5 to 9, further comprising a third sensor and/or fourth sensor positioned in or in proximity of the first and/or the second subjects (A, B) and configured to measure the quantities relating to the first and/or second subjects (A,

B) while in the bed (110) and to provide third and/or fourth signals, wherein the control unit is further configured to perform a third analysis, the third analysis including an analysis of the first, the second, the third, and/or the fourth signals and their interrelation in order to determine the effect of the event relating to the first and/or the second subjects (A, B), wherein the third and/or fourth sensors comprise audio sensors.

11. A computer program comprising computer code for causing performing the method of any of claims 1 to 4, when executed by an apparatus according to claim 5.

12. A memory medium comprising the computer program of claim 11.

Patentansprüche

1. Verfahren zur Schlafüberwachung, umfassend:

Messen (710a) einer Größe, die sich auf ein erstes Subjekt (A) bezieht, mit einem ersten Sensor, der an oder in der Nähe des ersten Subjekts (A) positioniert und konfiguriert ist zum Bereitstellen eines ersten Bewegungssignals;
Messen (710b) einer Größe, die sich auf ein zweites Subjekt (B) bezieht, mit einem zweiten Sensor, der an oder in der Nähe des zweiten Subjekts (B) positioniert und konfiguriert ist zum Bereitstellen eines zweiten Bewegungssignals;
wobei sich das erste Subjekt (A) und das zweite Subjekt (B) in einem Bett (110) befinden;
Analysieren, unter Verwenden einer Steuereinheit, des ersten Signals, des zweiten Signals und einer Wechselbeziehung des ersten Signals und des zweiten Signals, zum Bestimmen eines Bewegungsereignisses, das sich auf eines von dem ersten Subjekt oder dem zweiten Subjekt bezieht;
das Analysieren umfassend:

Erfassen einer ersten Signalamplitude, die mit dem Bewegungsereignis verknüpft ist, in dem ersten Signal und einer zweiten Signalamplitude, die mit dem Bewegungsereignis verknüpft ist, in dem zweiten Signal;
Vergleichen der ersten Signalamplitude mit der zweiten Signalamplitude und einer Verzögerung zwischen dem Bewegungsereignis in dem ersten Signal und dem Bewegungsereignis in dem zweiten Signal; und
Zuordnen des Bewegungsereignisses zu einem von dem ersten Subjekt oder dem zweiten Subjekt, basierend auf dem Ver-

gleich.

2. Verfahren nach Anspruch 1, wobei die Größen aus einer Gruppe ausgewählt werden, die umfasst: Herzfrequenz, Atmung, bewegungsbezogene Größe und Audio.

3. Verfahren nach einem der vorhergehenden Ansprüche, ferner umfassend Messen der Größen, die sich auf das erste und/oder zweite Subjekt (A, B) beziehen, während sie sich im Bett (110) befinden, mit einem dritten Sensor und/oder vierten Sensor, die in oder in der Nähe des ersten und/oder zweiten Subjekts (A, B) angeordnet und konfiguriert sind zum Bereitstellen eines dritten und/oder vierten Signals, das Verfahren ferner umfassend Durchführen einer dritten Analyse, wobei die dritte Analyse eine Analyse des ersten, des zweiten, des dritten und/oder des vierten Signals und ihrer Wechselbeziehung beinhaltet, um die Wirkung des Ereignisses zu bestimmen, das sich auf das erste und/oder zweite Subjekt (A, B) bezieht.

4. Verfahren nach einem der vorhergehenden Ansprüche, ferner umfassend Bereitstellen einer Schlafqualitätsbestimmung, basierend auf der Analyse.

5. Physiologisches Überwachungssystem (100) zur Schlafüberwachung einer Person während des Schlafens in einem Bett (110), umfassend:

einen ersten Sensor, der in dem Bett (110) positioniert und konfiguriert ist zum Messen einer Größe, die sich auf ein erstes Subjekt (A) bezieht, und zum Bereitstellen eines ersten Bewegungssignals;
einen zweiten Sensor, der in dem Bett positioniert und konfiguriert ist zum Messen einer Größe, die sich auf ein zweites Subjekt (B) bezieht, und zum Bereitstellen eines zweiten Bewegungssignals; und
eine Steuereinheit (150), die konfiguriert ist zum:

Analysieren des ersten Signals, des zweiten Signals und einer Wechselbeziehung des ersten Signals und des zweiten Signals zum Bestimmen eines Bewegungsereignisses, das sich auf eines von dem ersten Subjekt oder dem zweiten Subjekt bezieht;
das Analysieren umfassend:

Erfassen einer ersten Signalamplitude, die mit dem Bewegungsereignis verknüpft ist, in dem ersten Signal und einer zweiten Signalamplitude, die mit dem Bewegungsereignis verknüpft ist, in dem zweiten Signal;

Vergleichen der ersten Signalamplitude mit der zweiten Signalamplitude und einer Verzögerung zwischen dem Bewegungsereignis in dem ersten Signal und dem Bewegungsereignis in dem zweiten Signal; und
Zuordnen des Bewegungsereignisses zu einem von dem ersten Subjekt oder dem zweiten Subjekt, basierend auf dem Vergleich.

6. System (100) nach Anspruch 5, wobei die Größen aus einer Gruppe stammen, die umfasst: Herzfrequenz, Atmung, bewegungsbezogene Größe und Audio, und wobei die Ereignisse ausgewählt sind aus einer Gruppe, die umfasst: eine Anwesenheit des zweiten Subjekts (B), Bewegung des zweiten Subjekts (B) und Geräusche, die von dem zweiten Subjekt (B) erzeugt werden.
7. System (100) nach Anspruch 5 oder 6, wobei die Steuereinheit in ein Smartphone integriert ist.
8. System (100) nach einem der Ansprüche 5 bis 7, wobei die Steuereinheit konfiguriert ist zum Bereitstellen einer Schlafqualitätsbestimmung basierend auf der bestimmten Wechselbeziehung.
9. System (100) nach einem der Ansprüche 5 bis 8, wobei der erste und der zweite Sensor unauffällige Sensoren umfasst, wobei der erste und der zweite Sensor mindestens einen von Kraftsensoren, tragbaren Bewegungssensoren und Radaren umfasst.
10. System (100) nach einem der Ansprüche 5 bis 9, ferner umfassend einen dritten Sensor und/oder vierten Sensor, der in oder in der Nähe des ersten und/oder des zweiten Subjekts (A, B) positioniert und konfiguriert ist zum Messen der Größen, die sich auf das erste und/oder zweite Subjekt (A, B) beziehen, während sie sich im Bett (110) befinden, und zum Bereitstellen von dritten und/oder vierten Signalen, wobei die Steuereinheit ferner konfiguriert ist zum Durchführen einer dritten Analyse, wobei die dritte Analyse eine Analyse des ersten, des zweiten, des dritten und/oder des vierten Signals und ihrer Wechselbeziehung beinhaltet, um die Wirkung des Ereignisses bezüglich des ersten und/oder des zweiten Subjekts (A, B) zu bestimmen, wobei der dritte und/oder vierte Sensor Audiosensoren umfasst.
11. Computerprogramm, umfassend Computercode zum Veranlassen von Durchführen des Verfahrens nach einem der Ansprüche 1 bis 4, wenn es von einer Vorrichtung gemäß Anspruch 5 ausgeführt wird.
12. Speichermedium, das das Computerprogramm

nach Anspruch 11 umfasst.

Revendications

1. Un procédé de suivi du sommeil, comprenant :

la mesure (710a) d'une quantité relative à un premier individu (A) avec un premier capteur positionné sur le premier individu (A) ou à proximité et configuré pour produire un premier signal de mouvement ;
la mesure (710b) d'une quantité relative à un second individu avec un second capteur positionné sur le second individu (B) ou à proximité et configuré pour produire un second signal de mouvement ;
le premier individu (A) et le second individu (B) étant dans un lit (110);
l'analyse, à l'aide d'une unité de contrôle, du premier signal, du second signal et d'une interrelation du premier signal et du second signal pour déterminer un événement de mouvement relatif à l'un du premier individu ou du second individu, l'analyse comprenant :

la détection d'une première amplitude de signal associée à l'événement de mouvement dans le premier signal et d'une seconde amplitude de signal associée à l'événement de mouvement dans le second signal ;
la comparaison de la première amplitude de signal à la seconde amplitude de signal, et un délai entre l'événement de mouvement dans le premier signal et l'événement de mouvement dans le second signal ; et
l'attribution de l'événement de mouvement à l'un du premier individu ou du second individu sur la base de la comparaison.

2. Le procédé de la revendication 1, dans lequel les quantités sont choisies dans un groupe comprenant : rythme cardiaque, respiration, quantité liée au mouvement, et audio.
3. Le procédé de l'une des revendications précédentes, comprenant en outre la mesure des quantités relatives au premier et/ou au second individu (A, B) pendant qu'ils sont au lit (110) avec un troisième capteur et/ou un quatrième capteur positionnés sur le premier et/ou le second individu (A, B) ou à proximité et configurés pour produire un troisième et/ou un quatrième signal, le procédé comprenant en outre l'exécution d'une troisième analyse, la troisième analyse comprenant une analyse du premier, du second, du troisième et/ou du quatrième signal et de leur interrelation afin de déterminer l'effet de l'événement par rapport au premier et/ou au second in-

dividu (A, B).

4. Le procédé de l'une des revendications précédentes, comprenant en outre l'obtention d'une détermination de qualité du sommeil sur la base de l'analyse. 5

5. Un système de suivi physiologique (100) pour le suivi du sommeil d'une personne pendant qu'elle dort dans un lit (110), comprenant : 10
 - un premier capteur positionné dans le lit (110) et configuré pour mesurer une quantité relative à un premier individu (A) et pour produire un premier signal de mouvement ;
 - un second capteur positionné dans le lit et configuré pour mesurer une quantité relative à un second individu (B) et pour produire un second signal de mouvement ; et 15
 - une unité de contrôle (150) configurée pour :
 - analyser le premier signal, le second signal et une interrelation du premier signal et du second signal pour déterminer un événement de mouvement relatif à l'un du premier individu ou du second individu, l'analyse comprenant : 20
 - la détection d'une première amplitude de signal associée à l'événement de mouvement dans le premier signal et d'une seconde amplitude de signal associée à l'événement de mouvement dans le second signal ; 30
 - la comparaison de la première amplitude de signal à la seconde amplitude de signal, et un délai entre l'événement de mouvement dans le premier signal et l'événement de mouvement dans le second signal ; et 35
 - l'attribution de l'événement de mouvement à l'un du premier individu ou du second individu sur la base de la comparaison.

6. Le système (100) de la revendication 5, dans lequel les quantités font partie d'un groupe comprenant : rythme cardiaque, respiration, quantité relative au mouvement, et audio, et dans lequel les événements sont choisis dans un groupe comprenant : une présence du second individu (B), un mouvement du second individu (B), et des sons émis par le second individu (B). 40

7. Le système (100) de la revendication 5 ou 6, dans lequel l'unité de contrôle est intégrée à un smartphone. 50

8. Le système (100) de l'une des revendications 5 à 7, dans lequel l'unité de contrôle est configurée pour produire une détermination de qualité du sommeil sur la base de l'interrelation déterminée. 55

9. Le système (100) de l'une des revendications 5 à 8,

dans lequel le premier et le second capteur comprennent des capteurs non obstructifs, le premier et le second capteur comprenant au moins l'un parmi des capteurs de force, des capteurs de mouvement à porter sur soi et des radars.

10. Le système (100) de l'une des revendications 5 à 9, comprenant en outre un troisième capteur et/ou un quatrième capteur positionné sur le premier et/ou le second individu (A, B) ou à proximité et configuré pour mesurer les quantités relatives au premier et/ou au second individu (A, B) quand ils sont dans le lit (110), et pour produire un troisième et/ou un quatrième signal, l'unité de contrôle étant en outre configurée pour effectuer une troisième analyse, la troisième analyse comprenant une analyse du premier, du second, du troisième et/ou du quatrième signal et de leur interrelation afin de déterminer l'effet de l'événement relatif au premier et/ou au second individu (A, B), le troisième et/ou le quatrième capteur comprenant des capteurs audio.

11. Un programme informatique comprenant du code informatique pour faire en sorte de mettre en œuvre le procédé de l'une des revendications 1 à 4, lorsqu'il est exécuté par un appareil selon la revendication 5.

12. Un support de mémoire comprenant le programme informatique de la revendication 11.

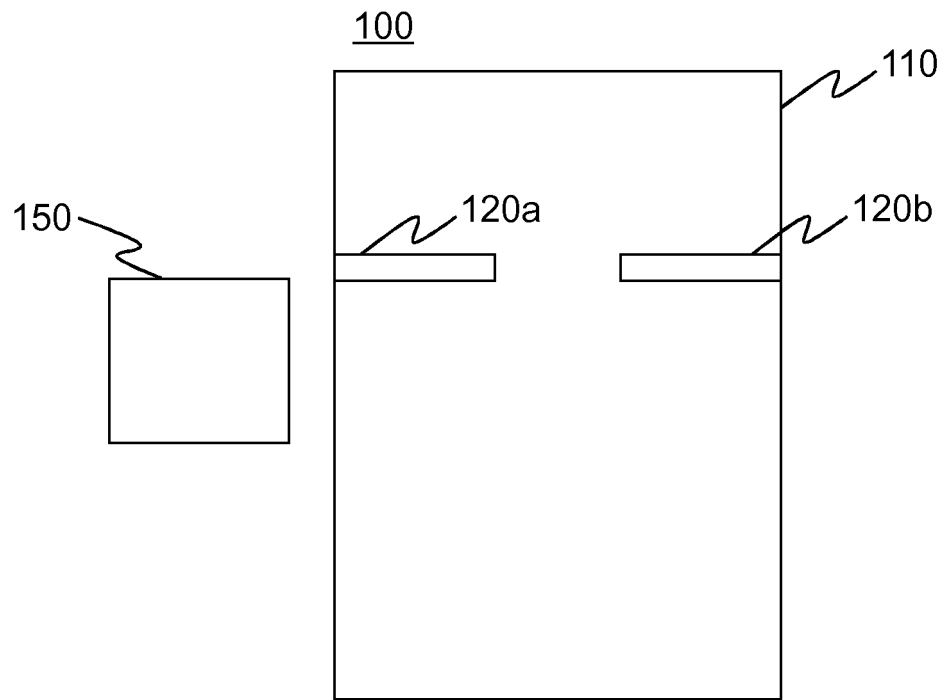


Fig. 1

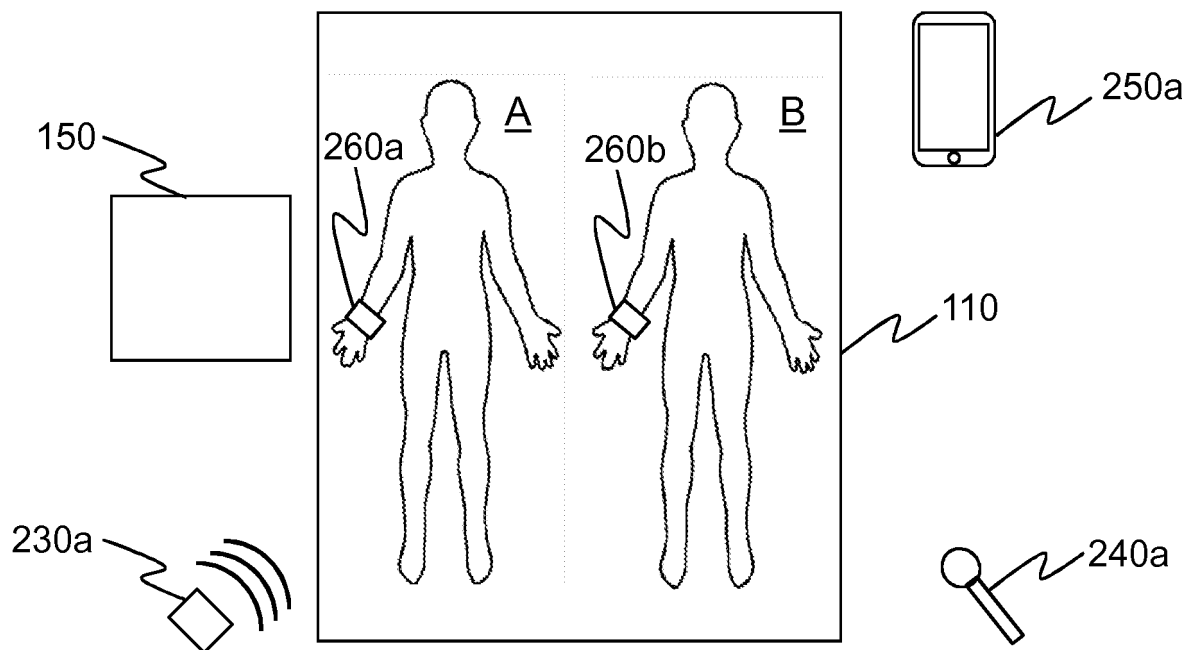
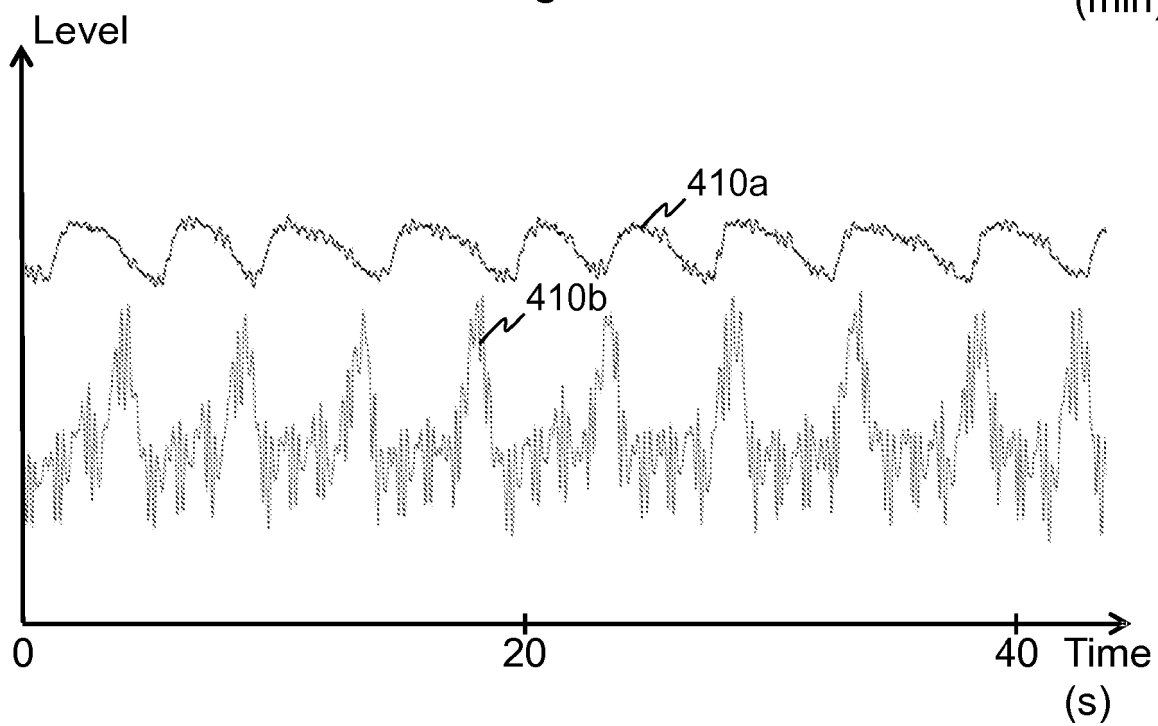
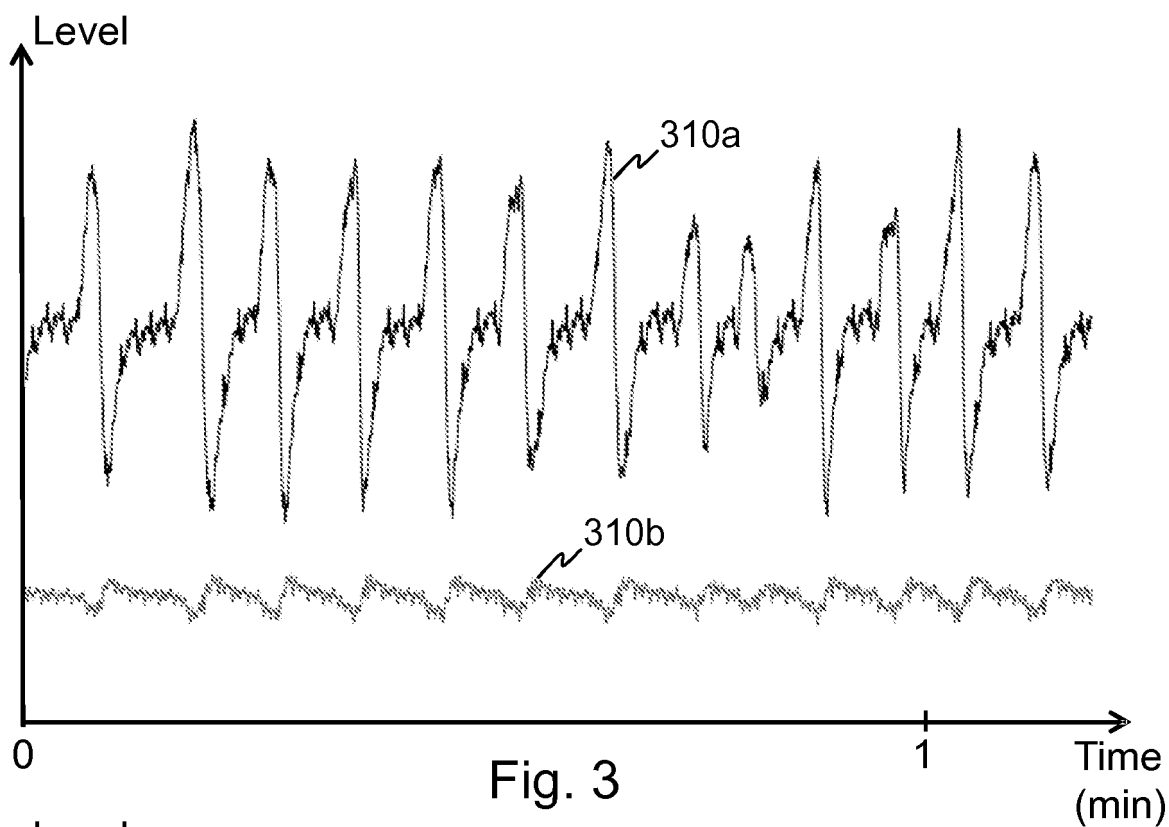
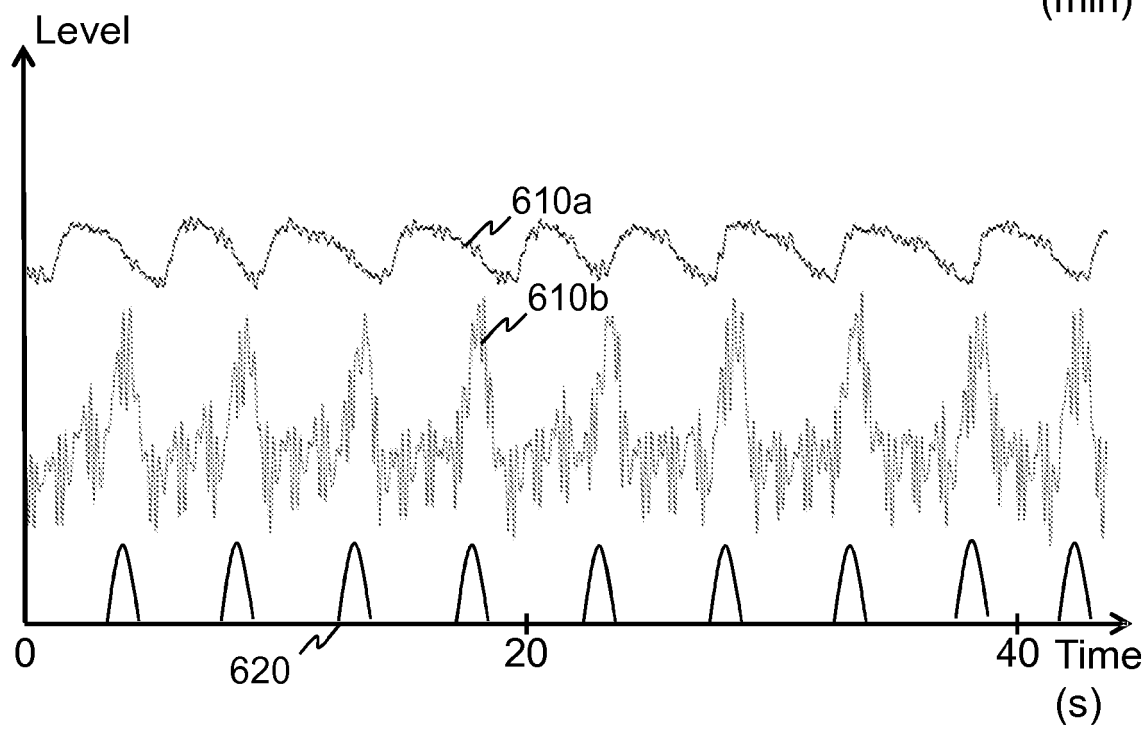
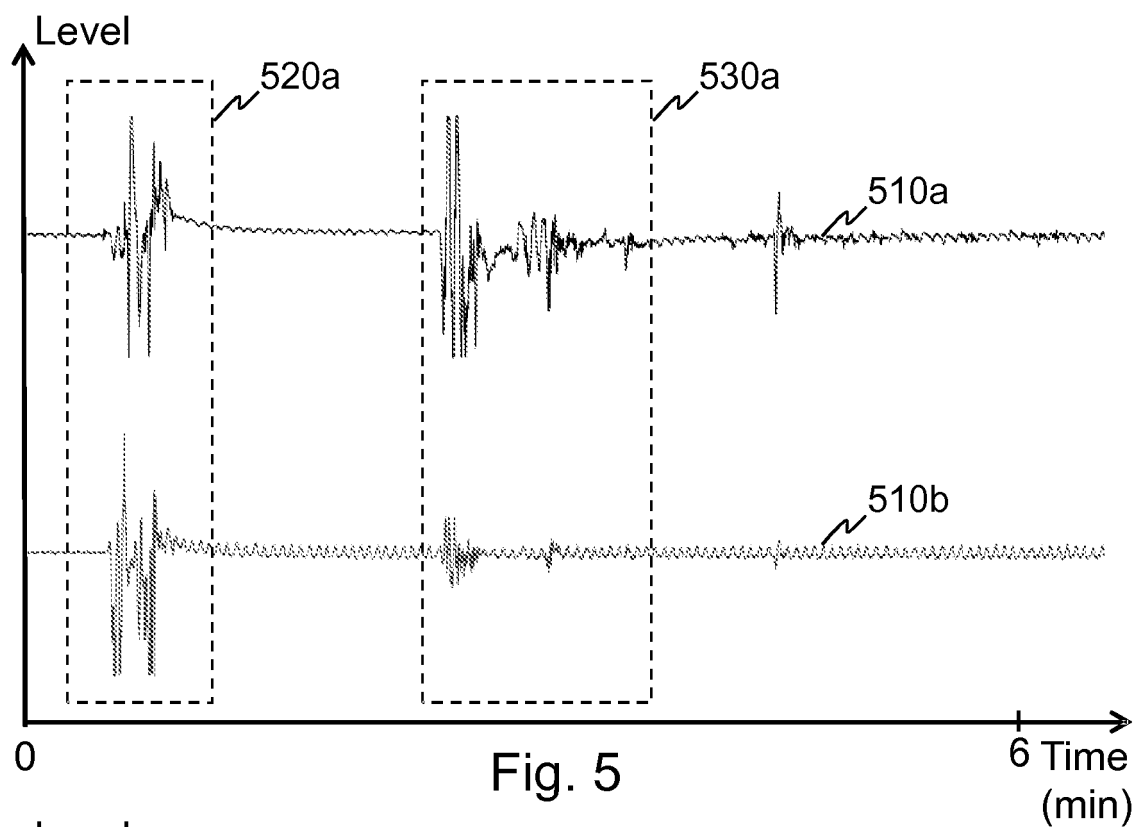


Fig. 2





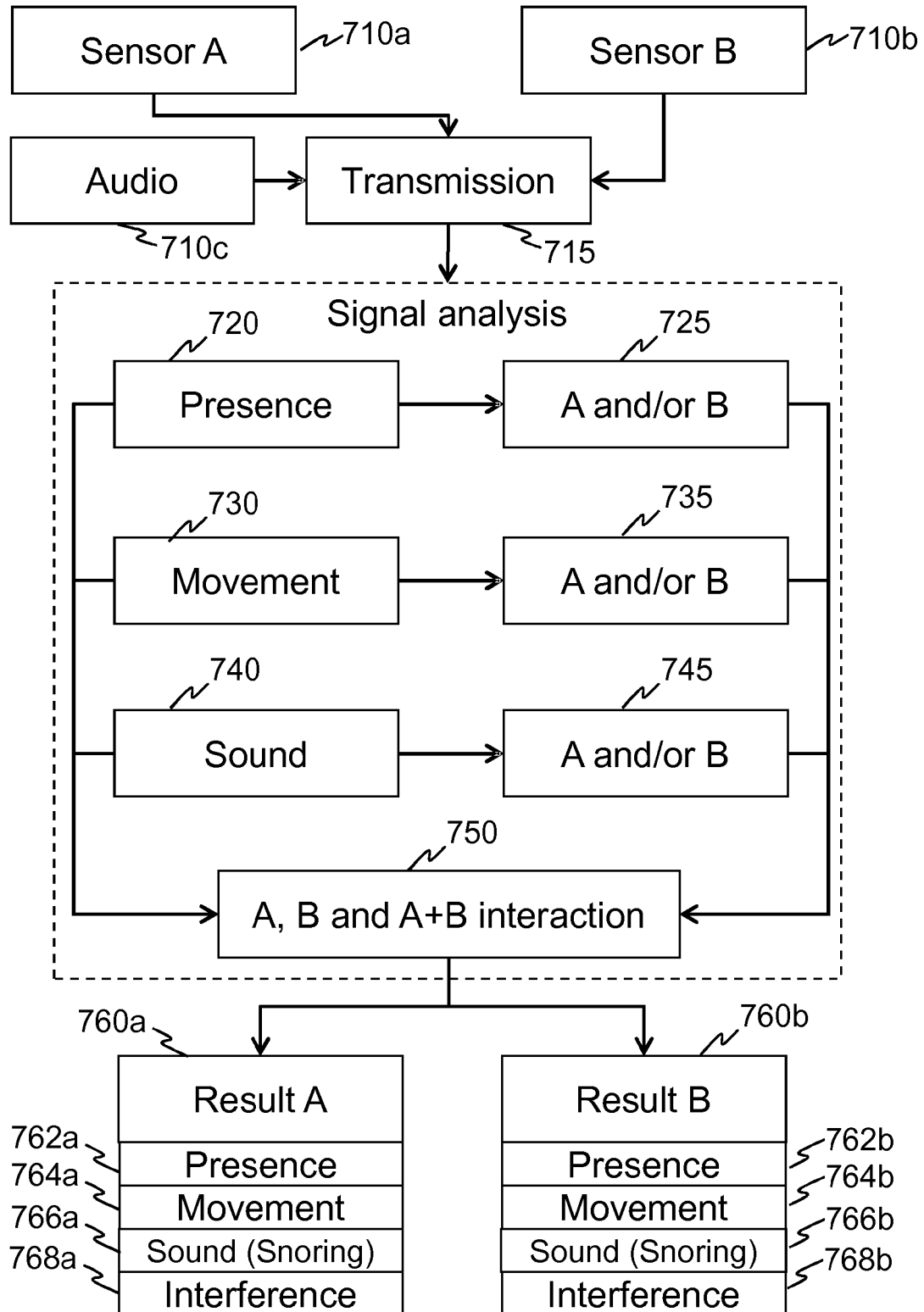


Fig. 7

REFERENCES CITED IN THE DESCRIPTION

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